

n8n Workshop Plan

Interactive 5-Session Training Series
Audience-Driven Live Demonstrations

Workshop Overview

Core Methodology

- Participants have no direct access to n8n
- All interactions happen through instructor as moderator
- Audience instructs what to click and build
- Collaborative problem-solving instead of individual coding
- Tool-agnostic approach with pre-session audience selection

Session 1: n8n Fundamentals - Express Version (45 Min)

Expected Learning Outcome

Participants can independently conceptualize a simple 3-node workflow (Trigger → Transformation → Action) and explain the basic logic of n8n workflows.

Specifically:

- Understand the difference between Trigger and Action Nodes
- Comprehend JSON data flow between nodes
- Translate a use case into node sequence
- Know where to search in n8n (Node Library, Credentials, Test Button)

Warm-Up & Tool Check (3 Min)

- Live Poll: "Which tools do you use for surveys today? Mentimeter/Slido/Kahoot/Other?"
- Decision: Top-voted tool will be used for this session
- Quick Poll: "Biggest automation pain points?"

n8n Lightning Tour (5 Min)

- Screen-share: Show Canvas, Node Library, Credentials
- Chat Activity: "Red circle emoji when you find HTTP Request, checkmark when you see Webhook"
- No deep-dive - orientation only

Live Demo: Minimal Workflow (20 Min)

- Audience chooses scenario (2 Min):
 - A) Form → Database → Email
 - B) Webhook → Slack Notification
 - C) Schedule → Data Fetch → Report
- Audience controls build (15 Min):
 - "Which trigger?" → Vote
 - "Where to store?" → Vote
 - "Tell me what to click"
 - 2-3 Prediction Games in between
- Test (3 Min): Live execution, audience predicts result

Key Concepts (10 Min)

- Audience question: "Which whiteboard tool? Miro/Mural/FigJam/Other?" → Vote
- Sketch 3 core concepts together on whiteboard:
 - Trigger vs. Action
 - Node chaining
 - JSON data
- Quick Quiz (3 questions) with chosen poll tool

Wrap-Up (7 Min)

- Learning Check: "Explain in one sentence: What is a trigger?"
- Deployment: Briefly mention Cloud vs. Self-Hosted (no depth)
- Homework: "Describe a workflow from your daily work - which nodes would you need?"
- Share Slack/Discord link for async exchange

Session 2: Early AI Integration (50 Min)

Expected Learning Outcome

Participants can integrate AI nodes (ChatGPT/Claude) into workflows, write prompts for structured outputs, and incorporate AI responses into subsequent processes.

Specifically:

- Configure and test AI nodes
- Master prompt engineering for structured JSON outputs
- Understand AI Output → Data Transformation → Forwarding
- Identify practical AI use cases (Email Triage, Content Summary, Sentiment)

Recap & Tool Check (5 Min)

- Audience chooses quiz tool: "Kahoot/Mentimeter/Slido for today's quiz?"
- 3-question speed quiz from Session 1

- Homework showcase (2 best answers)

AI Fundamentals Live (15 Min)

- Audience chooses use case:
 - A) Email Classification
 - B) Content Summarization
 - C) Sentiment Analysis
- Live build with ChatGPT/Claude Node:
 - Audience dictates prompt
 - "What should the AI output contain?"
 - Test 3 prompt variants
 - Live A/B comparison

AI Agent Workflow (20 Min)

- Compact Design Sprint:
 - Audience chooses whiteboard tool (Miro/Mural/FigJam)
 - Empathize (3 Min): "Which thinking work to automate?"
 - Design (5 Min): Draw workflow diagram together
 - Prototype (10 Min): Build live
 - Test (2 Min): Run with sample data

AI + Data Processing (8 Min)

- Show: AI Output → Data Transformation → Forwarding
- Audience instructs: "How do we clean AI output?"
- Set Node for data mapping
- Prediction game before test

Wrap-Up (2 Min)

- Learning Check: "What's the difference between good and bad AI prompts?"
- Homework: "Find an AI use case in your work - describe workflow with prompt example"
- Teaser for Session 3: "Error Handling & Production Readiness"

Session 3: APIs & Data Processing (55 Min)

Expected Learning Outcome

Participants can configure HTTP Request Nodes, set up API authentication, transform data between different systems, and orchestrate multi-system workflows.

Specifically:

- Configure HTTP Request Node with Auth (API Key, OAuth)
- Parse API responses and extract relevant data
- Use Set Node for field mapping
- Design 3-system workflows (Input → Transform → Output)
- Recognize and debug typical API errors

Energizer & Tool Check (5 Min)

- Audience chooses energizer format: "Quick Stand-Up/Emoji Check-In/One-Word Sharing?"
- Homework showcase
- Leaderboard update

API Basics (10 Min)

- Audience chooses API example:
 - A) CRM (HubSpot/Salesforce/Pipedrive)
 - B) Communication (Slack/Teams/Discord)
 - C) Data Storage (Airtable/Google Sheets/Notion)
- HTTP Request Node walkthrough
- Configure authentication together
- Test with prediction

Multi-API Workflow (25 Min)

- Audience chooses scenario:
 - A) Lead Capture → Enrichment → CRM
 - B) Support Ticket → AI Triage → Team Assignment
 - C) Content Publishing → Multi-Channel Distribution
- Jigsaw approach:
 - Audience divides into 3 groups (Chat or Breakouts)
 - Group 1: Input System
 - Group 2: Transformation/AI
 - Group 3: Output System
- Build based on all inputs:
 - Each group instructs their part
 - Error Detective Game in between
 - Debug session for problems

Data Transformation Deep-Dive (10 Min)

- Set Node vs. Code Node
- JSON manipulation
- Audience chooses: "Complex example or keep it simple?"
- Live mapping with their input

Wrap-Up (5 Min)

- Learning Check: "Name 3 steps to integrate a new API"
 - Pattern recognition: "Which pattern did we just build?"
 - Homework: "Analyze workflow screenshot: Which APIs? Which transformation? Find 1 error"
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Session 4: Production-Ready Workflows (55 Min)

Expected Learning Outcome

Participants can make workflows production-ready through error handling, conditional logic, and best practices. They understand how to build robust, maintainable automations.

Specifically:

- Apply IF/Switch Nodes for branching logic
- Implement Error Trigger and Retry Logic
- Know logging and monitoring strategies
- Apply production checklist (5+ criteria)
- Understand difference between "works" and "production-ready"

Check-In & Tool Selection (5 Min)

- Audience chooses quiz format: Tool vote
- Speed quiz Sessions 1-3
- Homework feedback

IF/Switch Logic (15 Min)

- Audience chooses use case:
 - A) Lead Scoring
 - B) Content Routing
 - C) Conditional Notifications
- Decision tree building:
 - Whiteboard tool: Audience vote
 - Design logic together
 - Build live
 - Branching prediction game

Error Handling Essentials (20 Min)

- Escape Room Challenge:
 - Show "broken" workflow
 - Audience finds 5 bugs
 - Fix together
- Error handling patterns:

- Retry Logic
- Fallback Actions
- Logging & Monitoring
- Audience chooses: "Which notification tool for errors? Slack/Email/Teams/Other?"

Production Checklist (10 Min)

- Case study (compact):
 - Show 2 production incidents
 - Audience analyzes in chat
 - Create checklist together on whiteboard
- Deployment best practices (Cloud vs. Self-Hosted)

Wrap-Up (5 Min)

- Learning Check: "Name 3 must-haves for production-ready workflows"
- Homework: "Your own production-ready workflow - apply checklist, document what you did"
- Teaser Session 5: "Capstone & Advanced Patterns"

Session 5: Capstone & Advanced Patterns (60 Min)

Expected Learning Outcome

Participants can independently design, build, and document end-to-end workflows. They know workflow patterns and can transfer them to new use cases. They are part of the n8n community.

Specifically:

- Execute own project from requirements to deployment
- Recognize and apply 3+ workflow patterns (Event-Driven, Scheduled, Orchestration)
- Give and receive peer feedback
- Document and share workflows
- Know where to find help (Community, Templates, Docs)

Recap & Celebration Prep (5 Min)

- Final leaderboard status
- Audience chooses showcase format: "Presentation/Gallery Walk/Quick Demos?"

Advanced Pattern Library (15 Min)

- Audience chooses whiteboard tool

- Collaborative mapping:
 - Event-Driven Pattern
 - Scheduled Pattern
 - API Orchestration Pattern
- Audience adds to board:
 - "When do I use what?"
 - "Examples from my work"
- Pattern matching quiz

Real-World Scenarios (15 Min)

- Audience chooses 2 out of 5 use cases: 100-point allocation
- Top 2 are played through together:
 - Requirements gathering (role-play if desired)
 - Workflow design on whiteboard
 - Identify key nodes
 - Build central parts live
 - Adaptation discussion

Capstone Project Kickoff (20 Min)

- Everyone starts their own workflow:
 - Requirements: 5+ Nodes, Error Handling, 1 Integration
 - Audience chooses mentoring format: Breakout Pairs / Open Office Hour Style / Async with Chat Support
- Provide real-time feedback:
 - Visit breakouts or moderate chat
 - Quick tips, pattern recognition
- Screenshot sharing in Slack

Celebration & Community (5 Min)

- Learning Check Final: "Which pattern did you use in your capstone and why?"
- Top 3 capstone workflows: Audience votes (Emoji/Poll)
- Final leaderboard + certificates
- Community setup:
 - Audience chooses: "Slack/Discord/Forum for continued exchange?"
 - Monthly office hours announcement
 - n8n Community Forum link

Learning Progression Across All Sessions

Session	Core Competency	Bloom's Level
1	Understanding	Understand & Apply (Basics)
2	AI Integration	Apply & Analyze
3	API Orchestration	Apply & Analyze
4	Production-Ready	Analyze & Evaluate
5	Own Projects	Evaluate & Create

Cumulative Learning

- **After Session 1:** Can sketch simple workflows
- **After Session 2:** Can build AI-powered automations
- **After Session 3:** Can orchestrate multi-system integrations
- **After Session 4:** Can deliver production-ready workflows
- **After Session 5:** Can independently execute complex automation projects